

How to enter SFF

Delving into your SFF roots isn't an easy process. Here are some practiced techniques of getting your ink on! <http://dgit.in/sffwriting>



Write Sci-Fi

Here's a website to help you write some good science-fiction. Rather innovatively called 'Write Sci-Fi' <http://dgit.in/wrtsyfy>

Tales from the Void

Prakrit Dhondiyal
readersletters@digit.in

Chapter One

Sometimes, it's the little things that push you over the edge; someone honking behind you in traffic, a beggar touching you on the street, a spilt drink, an inter-dimensional being trying to rip your heart out... you know, the small stuff.

The Foraxian stood, grinning, showing off her metallic teeth. Kit could see the blurry shadow of his heart on her outstretched palm, about to be teleported straight out of his body.

"That's the last straw. Diplomacy be damned", he thought. In a swift motion, he brought his blade down on her forearm, slicing through the force field surrounding her, and eventually through her metal arm, breaking the teleportation sequence.

Before she knew what had transpired, he grabbed her by her cold neck and slammed her into the wall. The force of the blow smashed through metal and wires, and her body slid to the floor like a shiny black rag doll, leaving her decapitated head staring at Kit with her swivelling eyes.

The reek of her rotting biomechanical fluids would have curled a skunk's nose hairs, but Kit leaned in close, with the calm and unfazed expression of someone who'd just chopped up some vegetables for dinner.

"Now. If we can discuss this like normal people, you may realise you have something to gain by not salvaging my organs for credits." He glanced down at the Foraxian's twitching pile of circuitry. "Or I

could always return the favour. I'm sure your body would fetch a pretty sum on the black market."

Kit felt a familiar grip on his shoulder and heard Conan's gruff voice behind him, "You know better than to start a fight in my pub, boy."

"Tell that to this wench. My heart is still half-out of phase."

Her face had a look inorganic incomprehension on it, undoubtedly trying to comprehend Kit's unusual ability to overpower her. But then again, she was a machine. Maybe he was imagining it.

"Boy. Either you take this outside, or I will. You've known me long enough to know I won't need any fancy teleportation to rip your heart out! "

There was a short pause. Kit counted down from six, as his therapist had taught him to. "Fine." He muttered through gritted teeth, and slid his hand-and-a-half back

into the scabbard around his waist, but kept a firm grip on the decapitated head "Could you ask Shalar to bring the body outside? I don't want to take my eyes off her head."

Conon chuckled, to Kit's relief. He knew he hadn't done anything wrong, but Conon's word was law within these walls – and without, to be honest, for a long, long way around. Bartenders were influential on every world.

"Shalar! You heard him."

The big blob of yellow muscle in the corner grunted and picked up the still-sparking body of the Foraxian and led the way out through the quiet crowd.

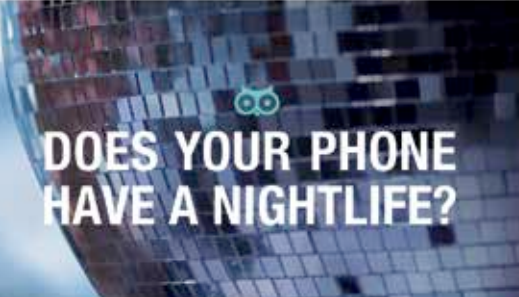
It was dark outside. Shalar plodded along with Kit right behind. He lugged the body onto the sidewalk next to Kit's 3049 Gravitrone, and stood there quietly.

"Thanks, Shalar. I think I can take it from here."











DOES YOUR PHONE HAVE A NIGHTLIFE?

SEE WHAT OTHERS CAN'T SEE. ZENFONE™ **PHOTOMASTER CAMERA.**
www.asus.in • Toll free No: 1800-2090-365 • facebook.com/ASUSIndia